Figure 15.6 A personal access token (PAT) granting permissions to trigger workflows in other repositories

Next, go to your Catalog Service repository on GitHub, navigate to the Settings tab, and then select Secrets > Actions. On that page, choose New Repository Secret, name it `DISPATCH_TOKEN` (the same name we used in listing 15.17), and input the value of the PAT you generated earlier. Using the Secrets feature provided by GitHub, we can provide the PAT securely to the acceptance stage workflow.

WARNING As explained in chapter 3, when using actions from the GitHub marketplace, you should handle them like any other third-party application and manage the security risks accordingly. In the acceptance stage, we provide an access token to a third-party action with permissions to manipulate repositories and workflows. You shouldn't do that light-heartedly. In this case, I trusted the author of the action and decided to trust the action with the token.

Don't commit your changes to the `catalog-service` repository yet. We'll do that later. At this point, we have implemented the trigger for the production stage, but we haven't initialized the final stage yet. Let's move on to the Polar Deployment repository and do that.

Open your Polar Deployment project (polar-deployment), and create a production-stage.yml file within a new .github/workflows folder. The production stage is triggered whenever the acceptance stage from an application repository dispatches an `app_ delivery` event. The event itself contains contextual information about the application name, image, and version for the newest release candidate. Since the application-specific information is parameterized, we can use this workflow for all the applications of the Polar Bookshop system, not only Catalog Service.

The first job of the production stage is updating the production Kubernetes manifests with the new release version. This job will consist of three steps: